6.3.3 Inheritance

To inherit the properties and methods from another class, use the extends keyword in the class definition, followed by the name of the base class:

```
class Person {
  var $name, $address, $age;
}

class Employee extends Person {
  var $position, $salary;
}
```

The Employee class contains the $position and $salary properties, as well as the $name, $address, and $age properties inherited from the Personclass.

I f a derived class has a property or method with the same name as one in its parent class, the property or method in the derived class takes precedence over, or *overrides*, the property or method in the parent class. Referencing the property returns the value of the property on the child, while referencing the method calls the method on the child.

Keyword

Clause consists of a subject and a verb and is the smallest grammatical unit that expresses a thought.

To access an overridden method, use the parent::*method*( ) notation:

```
parent::birthday();          // call parent class's birthday( ) method
```

A common mistake is to hardcode the name of the parent class into calls to overridden methods:

```
Creature::birthday( );       // when Creature is the parent class
```

This is a mistake because it distributes knowledge of the parent class's name all over the derived class. Using parent:: centralizes the knowledge of the parent class in the extends **clause**.

6.3.4 Constructors

You may also provide a list of arguments following the class name when instantiating an object: